No. 1 HINDU COLLEGE, DELHI



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

The Art of Learning

A REGULAR FEEDBACK MECHANISM HELPS HINDU COLLEGE KEEP AN EYE ON THE NEEDS OF THEIR STUDENTS AND GIVE THEM EXPOSURE BEYOND THE GENERAL CURRICULUM

By Sonali Acharjee

A major fear students had during Covid was that they would miss out on many of the exciting aspects of campus life with colleges closed in the lockdown. One of these was getting the chance to connect with professionals from various industries through guest lectures, something that Hindu College in Delhi always excelled at.

Realising this, the college took not only classes online but also its famed guest lectures. Over the past year, it has had leading personalities from various disciplines taking digital lectures. "We had economist Montek Singh Ahluwalia, lawyer Harish Salve and so many others come address us...in fact, the number of these guest lectures were more last year because it turned out to be logistically easier and more cost effective," says principal Anju Srivastava. Students also got to experience another important college component—the prestigious internships, where they get to work with various government ministries, the Rajya Sabha and the NITI Aayog. And thus, despite the challenges of Covid, most students felt the college had given them an environment of opportunities and engagement.

"The feedback surveys were very positive," smiles Srivastava. "Our needs analysis showed that while students were happy with what we put together, they also wanted exposure in AI, sustainability, climate change. Learning about all this helps the administration keep a focus and a target," adds Srivastava.

One major focus of the college was also mental health. The inhouse counsellor attended a variety of seminars and workshops to learn not just from other counsellors but also the students themselves about their worries, fears and experiences. "We are in constant touch with the counsellor and do regular meetings with all departments so that the teachers are involved.